



Issued By Communications Department

Date 30.01.2026

CCPI based headline inflation accelerated in January 2026

The Colombo Consumer Price Index (CCPI, 2021=100)¹ based headline inflation (year-on-year, Y-o-Y) accelerated in January 2026 after remaining at the same level for three consecutive months. Accordingly, headline inflation (Y-o-Y) was recorded at 2.3% in January 2026 compared to 2.1% in December 2025, broadly in line with the Central Bank's near-term projections.

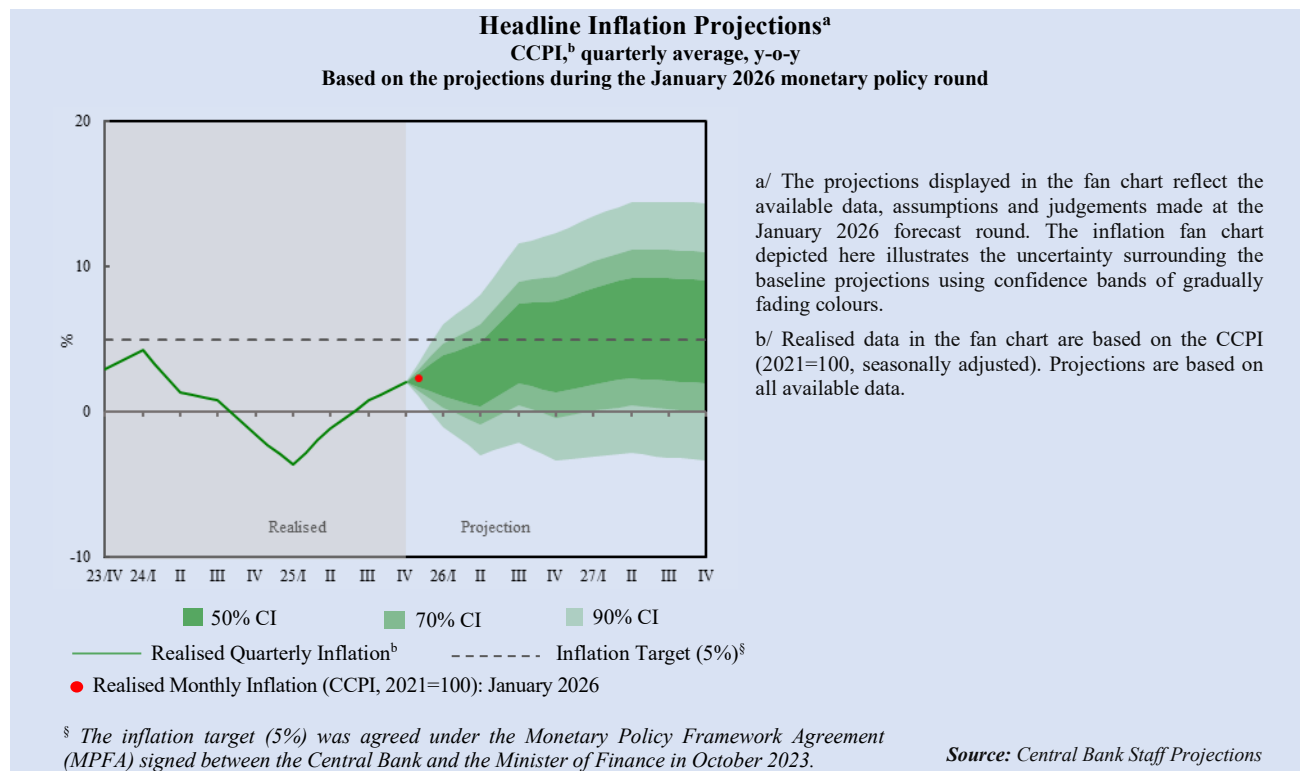
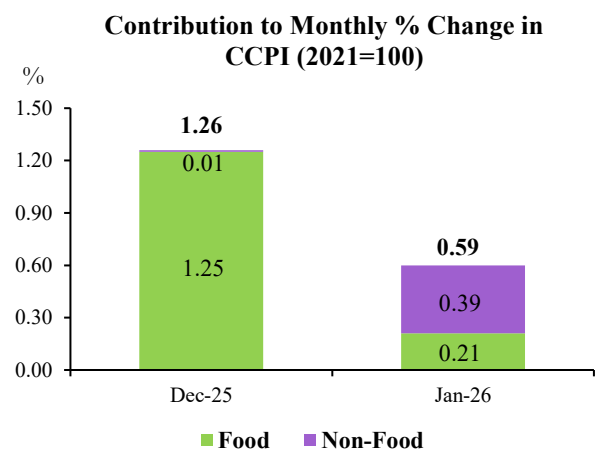
Food inflation (Y-o-Y) accelerated to 3.3% in January 2026 from 3.0% in December 2025, while Non-Food inflation (Y-o-Y) remained unchanged at 1.8% in January 2026 compared to the previous month.

On a month-on-month basis, the CCPI recorded an increase of 0.59% in January 2026. The Food category contributed 0.21 percentage points to this increase, while the Non-Food category contributed 0.39 percentage points.

Meanwhile, core inflation (Y-o-Y), which reflects the underlying inflation trends in the economy, decelerated to 2.3% in January 2026 from 2.7% in December 2025.

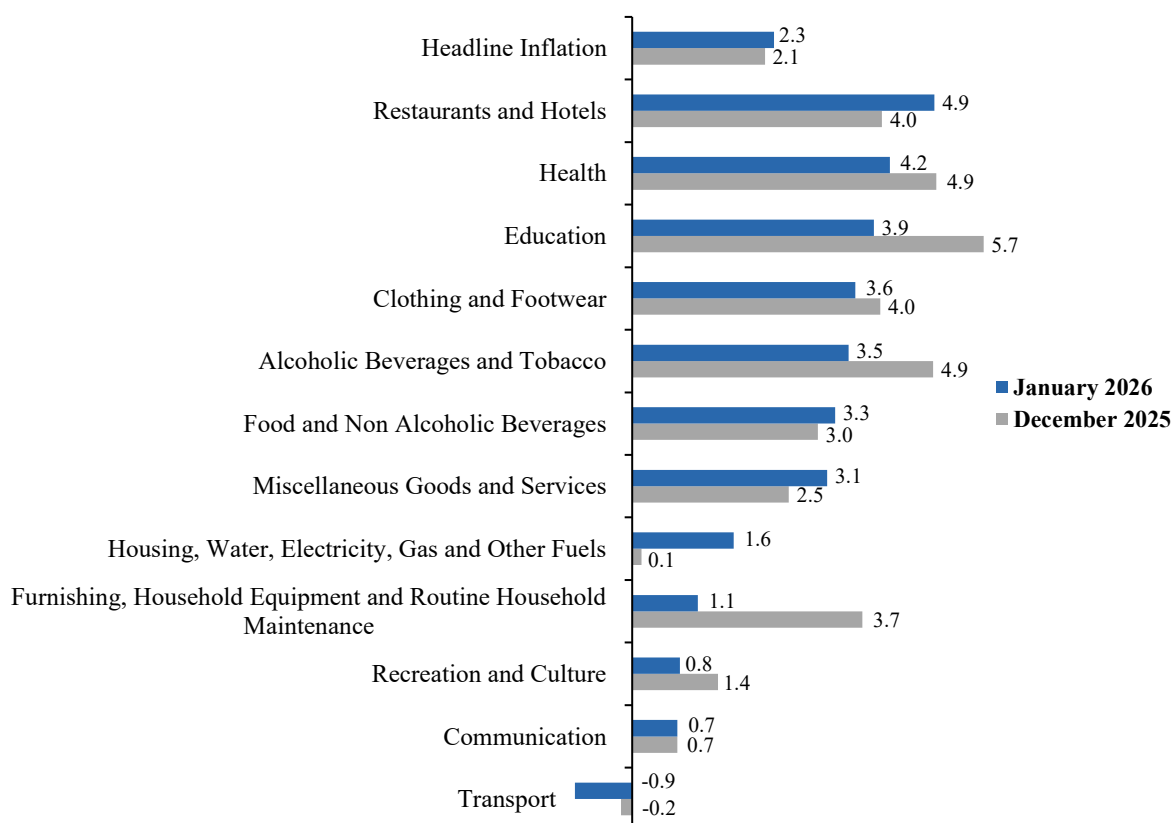
Inflation projections made at the monetary policy round in January 2026 indicate a gradual acceleration of inflation towards the target of 5% by the second half of 2026, with the support of appropriate policies.

Inflation CCPI (2021=100)	December 2025	January 2026
Index Value	195.8	197.0
Monthly Change (%)	1.2	0.6
Y-o-Y Inflation (%)	2.1	2.3



¹ The Colombo Consumer Price Index (CCPI, 2021=100) is compiled by the Department of Census and Statistics (DCS) to indicate average changes in the prices of goods and services purchased by households in urban areas of the Colombo district.

CCPI (2021=100) based Headline Inflation by Subcategory (Y-o-Y % Change)



Movement of the CCPI (2021=100)

Period		Index Number		Monthly % Change		Y-o-Y % Change		Annual Average % Change	
Year	Month	CCPI	CCPI (Core)	CCPI	CCPI (Core)	CCPI	CCPI (Core)	CCPI	CCPI (Core)
2025	January	192.6	178.4	0.5	0.7	-4.0	1.2	0.4	3.2
	February	192.2	178.5	-0.2	0.1	-4.2	0.7	-0.5	3.0
	March	191.6	178.6	-0.3	0.1	-2.6	0.7	-0.8	2.8
	April	191.2	178.8	-0.2	0.1	-2.0	0.8	-1.1	2.6
	May	192.8	179.2	0.8	0.2	-0.7	1.2	-1.2	2.4
	June	194.5	180.1	0.9	0.5	-0.6	1.5	-1.4	2.1
	July	194.1	180.8	-0.2	0.4	-0.3	1.6	-1.6	1.9
	August	193.3	180.9	-0.4	0.1	1.2	2.0	-1.5	1.8
	September	193.7	181.2	0.2	0.2	1.5	2.0	-1.4	1.7
	October	193.8	181.4	0.1	0.1	2.1	2.2	-1.2	1.6
	November	193.4	181.3	-0.2	-0.1	2.1	2.4	-0.8	1.6
	December	195.8	181.8	1.2	0.3	2.1	2.7	-0.5	1.6
2026	January	197.0	182.5	0.6	0.4	2.3	2.3	0.0	1.7

Source: Department of Census and Statistics

Note: As per DCS, Y-o-Y inflation and monthly change are calculated using the rounded off index numbers.